

PATNA INITIATIVE

Professional African Technical Network Advisory

Data Strategy Documentation

Step 3: Data Maturity Assessment

Are we truly capable of measuring what we promised?

Anchored to VP KPIs — Delivery on the PATNA Impact Promise

Framework: The 6-Step Data Strategy Roadmap | Status: Working Document | March 2026

"Designing a data strategy your organisation cannot execute is expensive theatre."

This document assesses PATNA's honest capability to measure its core promise — before building anything.

PART ONE

Reconstructing the Impact Promise

What Did PATNA Actually Promise?

Before any maturity assessment is meaningful, we must be precise about what PATNA's value proposition actually commits it to delivering. The promise is not a website, a community platform, or a set of published reports. Those are mechanisms. The promise is a specific change in the world that PATNA is accountable for producing.

PATNA's impact promise, reconstructed from its founding documents, programme work, and stated mission, consists of three interconnected claims:

COORDINATION Pillar 1	EVIDENCE Pillar 2	DECISION INTELLIGENCE Pillar 3
We convene the right African expertise into structured, purposeful collaboration — so Africa speaks with greater coherence in global processes.	We produce and curate knowledge grounded in African realities — so African positions in global negotiations are technically credible, not merely politically expressed.	We transform community and knowledge into action-ready tools and insights — so decision-makers act with confidence rather than improvise under pressure.

The Overarching Promise

PATNA strengthens Africa's agency in global energy transition and climate governance — by building coordinated, evidence-based positions through an expert community, so that international frameworks better reflect African realities, constraints, and aspirations.

Connecting the Promise to People, Planet, and Profit

PATNA's impact does not end with African negotiators sitting in rooms. The promise ultimately connects to three dimensions of value that justify PATNA's existence and ground its data strategy in the world beyond the organisation.

PEOPLE	PLANET	PROFIT / ECONOMIC
Direct beneficiaries:	Decarbonisation quality:	For African economies:

- African negotiators & policymakers with improved technical capacity - Governments making better-informed energy transition decisions - Civil society voices included in technical processes Indirect beneficiaries: - Communities whose energy access and livelihoods depend on transition quality - Future generations in Africa facing climate impacts	- IMO GHG Strategy implementation — shipping emissions pathway aligned with 1.5°C - Better-designed transition frameworks reduce risk of poorly-structured decarbonisation rules Just transition: - NDC quality and ambition improved through evidence-based national positions - Decarbonisation that doesn't impose disproportionate burdens on Africa	- Avoided costs of poorly-negotiated transition rules that penalise African trade and industry - Access to climate finance and technology transfer, better negotiated For PATNA's sustainability: - Demonstrated impact justifies grant funding, partnerships, and programme investment - Advisory services revenue enabled by credible track record
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Connecting the Promise to Global Goals

PATNA's work does not operate in isolation. It sits within and contributes to specific global frameworks. These frameworks provide the external reference points for measuring PATNA's ultimate impact — and they create accountability that is larger than PATNA itself.

Global Framework	PATNA's Specific Contribution	Observable Linkage for Measurement
IMO Revised GHG Strategy (2023) — Net-zero by/around 2050	Strengthening African state positions in MEPC sessions; ensuring just transition language is included in GHG strategy implementation measures	African state submissions to MEPC influenced by PATNA work; PATNA-supported positions reflected in IMO resolutions and circulars; African MEPC delegation members from PATNA network
UNFCCC Paris Agreement — NDCs & Just Transition	Improving quality of African NDCs through evidence; ensuring Africa's voice in Global Stocktake; contributing to Just Transition Work Programme	PATNA briefs cited in national communications; member participation in COP negotiations; quality of Africa Group positions on key agenda items
UNFCCC Article 11 — Capacity Building	PATNA is itself an institutional capacity-building mechanism for African technical expertise	Number of African negotiators with sustained PATNA network support; countries with improved delegation technical depth; returning members at successive negotiations
IMO — Mid-Term Measures on GHG Reduction	Ensuring African interests (island states, LDCs, oil-producing states) are represented in the design of levy and fuel transition mechanisms	African state positions on mid-term measures; specific amendments attributable to African bloc coordination via PATNA

SDG 7 (Clean Energy)	Supporting energy transition frameworks that expand access while decarbonising	PATNA knowledge outputs on energy access; policy positions balancing decarbonisation with access equity
SDG 13 (Climate Action)	Building Africa's institutional capacity for climate governance	Institutional strengthening indicators; African climate governance participation rates
SDG 16 (Strong Institutions)	Creating a durable institution with memory, governance, and continuity	PATNA organisational health indicators; knowledge system maturity; governance quality
SDG 17 (Partnerships)	Operating as a cross-sector, multi-country coordinating platform	Active partnerships; co-funded programmes; cross-continental representation in membership

Critical Measurement Insight

The connection to IMO and UNFCCC outcomes is real but indirect. PATNA does not control what negotiators decide in rooms — it improves the quality of what African representatives bring to those rooms. The correct measurement question is therefore not 'Did PATNA change the IMO GHG Strategy?' but 'Did PATNA-supported African positions reach the table, were they technically credible, and were they reflected in outcomes?' This distinction protects PATNA from impossible attribution claims while still committing to meaningful impact measurement.

The Theory of Change — Data Version

To measure whether the promise is being delivered, PATNA needs a Theory of Change expressed in data terms. This chain connects what PATNA does (inputs and activities) to what changes in the short term (outputs), medium term (outcomes), and long term (impact). Each stage requires different data, collected at different cadences, with different attribution assumptions.

INPUTS	ACTIVITIES	OUTPUTS	OUTCOMES	IMPACT
Expert network (4 cohorts) Knowledge assets Secretariat capacity Funding & partnerships	Event convening Knowledge production Community management Policy engagement	Events held & documented Publications produced Members onboarded & active Policy submissions made	Coordinated African positions Evidence-based briefs in use Strengthened negotiator capacity Improved institutional memory	African agency in global climate & energy processes Better-designed international frameworks Just transition outcomes for Africa
Platform infrastructure Governance model Data architecture	Community management Knowledge tagging AI-augmented tools (Phase 2)	Platform engagement data Content uptake metrics Member growth & retention	Knowledge reuse by practitioners Decision-maker confidence Africa Group coordination quality	Contribution to IMO GHG targets Quality of African NDCs SDG 7, 13, 16, 17 progress

The critical observation is that the further right along this chain, the harder the measurement becomes — and the more attribution complexity must be acknowledged. PATNA's data strategy must be honest about what it can measure directly (outputs), what it can triangulate through proxies (outcomes), and what it can only claim contribution to (impact).

PART TWO

VP KPI Readiness: Can We Even Measure the Promise?

The Central Question This Step Must Answer

Step 2 defined the KPIs for the Value Proposition block. The most pressing question for this maturity assessment is blunt: does PATNA currently have the data, the processes, or the systems to know whether it is actually delivering on its three-pillar promise?

Honest Starting Point

As of March 2026, PATNA cannot definitively answer any of its three core VP questions with data. It cannot show with evidence how coordinated Africa's voice has become through its work. It cannot demonstrate the uptake and influence of its knowledge outputs. It cannot show how its community has improved the quality of decision-making by African actors. This is not a failure — it is the baseline. The data strategy exists to change this.

VP Pillar 1 — Coordination: Can We Measure It?

The coordination promise says: 'We convene African expertise into purposeful collaboration so Africa speaks with greater coherence.' To verify this, PATNA would need to track participation across events and community spaces, the quality of deliberation and position development, and evidence of improved coherence in global process contributions by African actors who engaged with PATNA.

VP Pillar	Measurement Needed	Data Available Today	Maturity Gap
Coordination — Community engagement depth	Active member participation rate; cohort space discussion activity; event co-attendance patterns	None — no community platform yet; engagement undocumented	Critical gap: no system exists to capture any engagement data at this level
Coordination — Position coherence	Evidence of shared language, coordinated submissions, or aligned stances across African delegations following PATNA convenings	None — no tracking of negotiation outcomes or cross-member position alignment	Level 1: not even theorised as a measurement point; no methodology exists
Coordination — Event-to-outcome chain	Event attendance → follow-up actions → policy contributions by attendees	Partial: event records exist but are not linked to any follow-up data	Level 1: event data is captured but siloed; no linkage to outcomes

Coordination Network depth —	Multi-cohort connections; repeat interaction rate; cross-constituency collaboration evidence	None — member relationships are invisible in current systems	Critical gap: no relationship or network data captured
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VP Pillar 2 — Evidence: Can We Measure It?

The evidence promise says: 'We produce and curate knowledge grounded in African realities so positions are technically credible.' Measuring this requires tracking what knowledge PATNA produces, whether it reaches intended users, whether users find it credible and applicable, and whether it influences the positions actually taken in international processes.

VP Pillar	Measurement Needed	Data Available Today	Maturity Gap
Evidence Knowledge — production volume & quality	Publications by type, theme, geography, cohort relevance; citation tracking; peer review or validation status	Partial: content exists but is scattered, untagged, and not inventoried in a searchable system	Level 1-2: content exists but has no usable taxonomy or discovery infrastructure
Evidence Knowledge uptake and reach —	Download counts, view analytics, external citations, user feedback on applicability	None — no analytics connected to content; no download tracking; no citation monitoring	Level 1: knowledge is published but its reach is entirely invisible
Evidence — Evidence-to-position linkage	Tracking when PATNA-produced evidence is used in national position papers, delegation briefs, or negotiating text	None — no methodology for tracking downstream use of PATNA content by practitioners	Level 1: this data does not exist and no process captures it
Evidence Knowledge — gap identification	Systematic process for identifying what evidence is missing relative to active policy processes	None — content decisions are ad-hoc; no analysis of the policy calendar vs. knowledge availability	Level 1: reactive rather than strategic knowledge production

VP Pillar 3 — Decision Intelligence: Can We Measure It?

The decision intelligence promise says: 'We transform community and knowledge into action-ready tools so decision-makers act with confidence.' This is the most ambitious pillar and currently the furthest from measurement readiness — the capability does not yet fully exist, let alone the measurement infrastructure for it.

VP Pillar	Measurement Needed	Data Available Today	Maturity Gap
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Decision Intelligence — Tool availability and use	Number of decision-support tools, briefs, or AI-augmented outputs available; user adoption rate; self-reported confidence	None — AI layer does not exist (Phase 2); no structured decision tools currently in place	Level 1: the capability is aspirational; the measurement infrastructure is entirely absent
Decision Intelligence — Decision quality improvement	Self-reported or observed improvement in negotiator confidence, preparation quality, or decision-making speed	None — no mechanism to survey or observe this; no baseline established	Level 1: no baseline, no methodology, no capture mechanism
Decision Intelligence — AI readiness for measurement	Data structures, tagging, and indexing sufficient to support RAG-based retrieval and query analytics	Low — content is unstructured and untagged; not queryable; no knowledge graph	Level 1-2: the knowledge architecture prerequisite for decision intelligence does not yet exist

Synthesis: VP Measurement Readiness

Across all three pillars of the impact promise, PATNA's measurement readiness is at Level 1 — Initial. Data either does not exist, is not captured, or exists in silos that prevent any meaningful analysis. This is the most critical constraint in the entire data strategy. Building the platform is necessary. But building the measurement architecture — the tagging systems, the engagement tracking, the feedback loops, the policy linkage methodology — is equally urgent and must be designed in parallel.

PART THREE

Five Pillar Data Maturity Assessment

Assessment Methodology

The five-pillar maturity assessment evaluates PATNA's current data capability across People & Culture, Processes, Technology, Governance, and Strategy & Impact. Each pillar is scored on a 1–5 scale based on observable evidence. The assessment is grounded in VP KPI readiness — because the goal is not abstract data sophistication but the specific capability to know whether PATNA's impact promise is being delivered.

This assessment reflects the current state as of March 2026 — before the platform build. It is deliberately honest. Inflated scores protect no one; accurate scores enable the right interventions.

Level	Label	What It Means
1	Initial	Ad-hoc and manual. Things work because specific people make them work. No documentation, no systems, high person-dependency.
2	Managed	Repeatable but fragile. Processes exist but aren't documented. If the right person is absent, things break. Growing awareness of the problem.
3	Defined	Documented and standardised. Processes written down, roles clear, new people can be onboarded. Dashboards may exist.
4	Integrated	Connected and cross-functional. Systems talk to each other, data flows across teams. Single source of truth emerging.
5	Optimised	Data-led and continuously improving. Evidence drives decisions. Feedback loops refine the system. Learning is systematic.

Pillar-by-Pillar Assessment

Pillar 1: People & Culture

This pillar asks: do the people in PATNA use data to make decisions? Do they trust data? Do they understand why metrics matter to the mission?

- The Secretariat team operates primarily from experience, relationships, and instinct — these are genuinely valuable, but they are not supported by data.
- There is awareness within the team that data matters, especially for funder reporting, but this has not yet translated into routine data-informed decision-making.
- Cohort leads and members have no structured data environment to engage with — there is nothing to develop a data culture around yet.

- The framing of the platform build itself demonstrates growing strategic awareness: the platform is being designed as a data architecture, not just a community tool. This is a positive cultural signal.
- The team understands the theory of impact measurement but lacks the tools and processes to practise it.

Pillar 1 Score: Level 2 — Managed

Evidence: Secretariat has awareness of metrics importance; funder reporting creates some demand for data discipline; strategy documents demonstrate sophisticated thinking about impact. Constraint: No data-informed decision culture exists in day-to-day operations; decisions are relationship and experience-driven; no data literacy practice or infrastructure to build on.

Pillar 2: Processes

This pillar asks: how reliably does data flow through PATNA's activities? Are processes documented? What breaks when someone is absent?

- Onboarding is conducted via email with no structured workflow, no stage tracking, and no documented process. It works because of Secretariat familiarity, not because of a defined system.
- Content publishing is ad-hoc — articles, briefs, and reports are produced and shared through channels that vary by occasion. There is no publishing pipeline, no tagging discipline, and no editorial calendar.
- Event processes have informal playbooks but these are not written down. Event outputs (learnings, proceedings, attendee data) are not systematically captured or stored.
- Member engagement is conducted entirely through email and personal relationships with no CRM, no stage tracking, and no follow-up logging.
- Grant reporting relies on the Secretariat assembling data retrospectively — not from a live data system but from emails, notes, and memory.

Pillar 2 Score: Level 1–2 — Initial to Managed

Evidence: Core activities happen and deliver results, demonstrating operational capability. But almost every process is person-dependent and undocumented. Constraint: No process documentation exists for onboarding, publishing, event management, or member engagement. The absence of the platform is the primary structural barrier — without it, no data process can be meaningfully standardised.

Pillar 3: Technology

This pillar asks: what tools exist to store, process, and surface data? Are they connected? Do they support decision-making?

- Current website: provides basic CMS functionality for public content. No member management, no analytics beyond basic page view data, no community functionality.

- Email (likely Gmail/Outlook): primary relationship management tool. All member correspondence, application processing, and follow-up sits in email inboxes — unsearchable at scale, person-dependent, not structured.
- Spreadsheets: member lists, event registrations, and financial tracking are managed in spreadsheets. These work but create multiple versions of truth, are not shared in real time, and do not connect to each other.
- No CRM. No community platform. No knowledge management system. No analytics dashboard. No data pipeline. No AI infrastructure.
- The platform build (Phase 1 MVP) will jump this pillar from Level 1 to approximately Level 2–3, establishing: a CMS with unified content management, a member database, community spaces, and basic engagement analytics.
- The platform must be designed from the start with the VP measurement architecture in mind — not retrofitted after it's built.

Pillar 3 Score: Level 1 — Initial

Evidence: Functional website; email; spreadsheets. These handle basic operations but generate no actionable data and do not connect to each other. Constraint: No platform infrastructure for community, knowledge, or analytics. Platform MVP (Phase 1) is the immediate critical path investment that will change this pillar's score most rapidly.

Pillar 4: Governance

This pillar asks: who owns each dataset? Who defines what KPIs mean? How is quality ensured? Are privacy and ethics built in?

- No formal data ownership exists. The Secretariat owns everything by default, but 'ownership' in practice means having access to the email inbox.
- Key definitions — 'active member', 'engaged partner', 'policy contribution', 'knowledge output' — do not have agreed operational definitions. Different people would describe these differently.
- Privacy considerations exist at a policy level (GDPR awareness, member confidentiality) but there is no formal data protection framework, no privacy notice for member data, and no documented data retention policy.
- The upcoming platform build creates an urgent governance decision point: who defines the taxonomy? Who approves publishing? Who owns member data? These must be decided before the platform goes live, not after.
- Positively: the cohort structure and role-based permissions model in the data model document demonstrates that governance thinking has begun — this is a real foundation to build on.

Pillar 4 Score: Level 1 — Initial

Evidence: Role-based permissions model in platform design shows governance awareness. Privacy is considered at a policy level. Constraint: No data owners formally assigned; no agreed definitions of key terms; no data quality standards; no formal privacy framework for member data. This pillar must be addressed in parallel with the platform build — governance decisions baked in after the fact are significantly harder and riskier.

Pillar 5: Strategy & Impact

This pillar asks: do KPIs actually influence decisions? Is data reviewed at leadership level? Can PATNA point to specific data-informed strategic choices?

- The PATNA Impact Metrics document (PDF) demonstrates that impact thinking exists and is sophisticated — the organisation can articulate what it is trying to achieve and how it connects to global goals.
- However, impact metrics are currently aspirational, not operational. They describe what PATNA wants to measure, not what it can measure today.
- Funder reporting creates some demand for impact evidence, which is positive. But current reporting is assembled retrospectively from activity records and narrative, not from live data.
- The data strategy process itself — the fact that PATNA is building this documentation — is evidence of growing strategic intent to ground decision-making in evidence.
- The key next step is operationalising the Theory of Change into a live measurement framework, with defined data collection points, regular review cadences, and accountability for acting on insights.

Pillar 5 Score: Level 2 — Managed

Evidence: Sophisticated impact articulation in strategy documents; funder reporting creates data demand; active data strategy development process underway. Constraint: Impact metrics are aspirational, not operational; no live data feeds into strategic decisions; no regular cadence of evidence-based strategic review. The gap between intention and practice is the constraint.

Maturity Baseline Summary

Pillar	Score	Level	Supporting Evidence	Primary Constraint	Next Target
People & Culture	2	Managed	Growing strategic awareness; funder reporting demands create some data discipline; sophisticated impact thinking in documents	No data literacy practice; no data-informed day-to-day decisions; nothing to build a data culture around yet	Level 3: Defined
Processes	1.5	Initial–Managed	Activities deliver results, demonstrating operational capability. But every process is person-dependent and undocumented	No documented workflows; platform absence prevents standardisation; onboarding, publishing, and engagement all ad-hoc	Level 2: Managed
Technology	1	Initial	Functional website, email, spreadsheets — sufficient for current	No platform infrastructure; no CRM; no	Level 3: Defined

Governance			scale but generate no actionable data and do not connect	analytics; no knowledge system. Platform MVP is the critical path intervention	
	1	Initial	Role-based permissions model in platform design; policy-level privacy awareness; cohort structure provides governance scaffolding	No data owners assigned; no agreed definitions; no privacy framework for member data; governance decisions pending before platform launch	Level 2: Managed
Strategy & Impact	2	Managed	Sophisticated impact articulation in documents; active data strategy process; Theory of Change developed and grounded	Impact metrics aspirational not operational; no live data in strategic decisions; no review cadence for evidence-based planning	Level 3: Defined

The Limiting Pillar

The most important rule of maturity assessment: the lowest pillar sets the ceiling for the entire data strategy. An organisation cannot compensate for Level 1 governance with Level 4 technology.

PATNA's Limiting Constraint: Technology & Governance (tied at Level 1)

Both Technology and Governance are at Level 1 — Initial. Technology cannot advance without the platform build; Governance cannot be enforced without a platform to govern. These two pillars are codependent and must be addressed simultaneously. The platform must be built with governance decisions pre-made: data owners named, definitions agreed, taxonomy fixed, privacy framework in place. Building the platform without governance decisions creates technical debt that is very hard to unwind. The practical implication: governance design work must begin now, in parallel with technical development.

Realistic Next-Level Targets

Maturity improves one level at a time. The following targets are achievable within a 12-month horizon, tied to the platform build and its post-launch operations. They represent the minimum capability needed to begin measuring the VP promise with credibility.

Pillar	Current	12-Month Target	What Makes It Possible	VP KPI It Unlocks
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People & Culture	Level 2	Level 3 — Defined	Platform launch creates data to engage with; named data champions in Secretariat and cohort leads; VP measurement framework made visible to team	Team begins reviewing VP KPIs in regular leadership rhythm
Processes	Level 1.5	Level 2–3 — Managed to Defined	Platform enforces process discipline: onboarding workflow, publishing pipeline, community moderation — all systematised in the platform	Coordination and evidence KPIs captured as platform usage data; lifecycle tracking begins
Technology	Level 1	Level 3 — Defined	Platform MVP delivers: member database, community spaces, Insights Hub with tagging, basic analytics. Phase 2 adds AI layer and knowledge indexing	All three VP pillar measurement chains begin generating real data for the first time
Governance	Level 1	Level 2 — Managed	Pre-launch governance sprint: data owners named, definitions agreed, taxonomy built, privacy framework published, publishing approval rules set	Consistent data definitions enable meaningful KPI comparison over time
Strategy & Impact	Level 2	Level 3 — Defined	Theory of Change operationalised into a live measurement dashboard; quarterly VP review cadence established; funder reporting rebuilt from platform data	VP KPIs move from aspirational to operational; PATNA can begin making data-backed claims about coordination, evidence uptake, and decision quality

Conclusion: What This Assessment Tells Us

PATNA is at the beginning of its data maturity journey. This is not a crisis — it is a baseline. The organisation has been delivering real work and building real relationships with real impact, entirely without a data infrastructure to support it. The question the data strategy now asks is: can we systematise what we know, measure what we claim, and improve what we do — with evidence rather than instinct?

The answer requires addressing two parallel constraints before anything else:

- Build the platform — which advances Technology from Level 1 to Level 3 and enables process standardisation across Processes, People & Culture, and Strategy & Impact.

- Design governance in parallel — which prevents the platform from becoming ungoverned data infrastructure; names owners, fixes definitions, sets rules, and creates accountability.

The VP KPI readiness review is the most urgent output of this step. PATNA currently has no measurement infrastructure for any of its three promise pillars. This is the specific capability gap the platform build — and the data strategy that governs it — must close.

Next Step: Data Lifecycle Mapping

Step 4 maps exactly where, in the flow of PATNA's three core processes — community coordination, knowledge production, and policy influence — data breaks down before it becomes a decision. The gaps identified in this maturity assessment predict where those breakdowns will be found.